

TO: NeuroWorks Project Team
FROM: Pia, Procurement Officer
DATE: July 15, 2026
RE: Procurement Evaluation & Improvement Review: NeuroWorks AI Digital Workforce Platform Proposal (AI4I Track 3)

Executive Summary

As Procurement Officer, I have evaluated the *NeuroWorks AI Digital Workforce and Intelligent Organisation Platform* Track 3 Development Proposal [Attachment 1] against the provided *Terms of Reference (ToR) for Track 3 Development* [Attachment 2].

From a procurement and commercial viability perspective, the proposal is **highly competitive and strategically aligned**, but it contains critical structural gaps and single-source risks that must be resolved before formal submission. Below is the formal evaluation, total cost of ownership (TCO) analysis, key takeaways, and actionable improvement areas.

Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) & Proposal Comparison

To evaluate the proposal's commercial positioning, we compare the proposed local-first hybrid architecture against a standard cloud-only SaaS deployment model.

Cost & Risk Category	Proposed Local-First Hybrid Model (NeuroWorks)	Standard Cloud-Only SaaS Model (Alternative)	Procurement Rating & Notes
Initial Setup & Capex	Moderate (Requires local consumer GPUs or ZCHPC integration) [Attachment 1, 1.4]	Low (No local infrastructure required)	Favorable: Local deployment leverages existing hardware, reducing long-term SaaS lock-in.
Operating Costs (Opex)	Low (62.7% of inference runs locally on consumer GPUs; minimal cloud egress) [Attachment 1, 1.4]	High (Ongoing per-token and subscription fees; high data egress costs)	Highly Favorable: Significant long-term operational savings.
Data Sovereignty	Extremely Low (AES-256-GCM local encryption; data	High (Data exported to foreign cloud	Excellent: Directly aligns with Zimbabwe National

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& Risk	stays on-premise) [Attachment 1, 1.4]	environments)	AI Strategy [Attachment 1, 1.4].
Switching Costs	High (Custom-built local policy integrations and sector packs) [Attachment 1, 1.4]	Medium (Standard API	